

at once, rotating their personnel and making the market in dozens of different stocks.

To me, the most interesting part was that each specialist carried a "Book" on each stock. The Book was a record of all the orders that came in from various buyers and sellers, mostly from big institutional clients who dealt in thousands of shares. Mr. Hayes said that the Book enabled any specialist to tell at a glance "who's selling big or who's buying big, and at what prices, and where's the available supply."

I thought having a Book like that would be a wonderful advantage. Mr. Hayes agreed up to a point, but also cautioned that specialists can lose money even with a Book, that "their biggest fear is one-way markets when they can't reverse their positions," and that "they see only part of the puzzle." Even so, I figured they had to see a more useful part of the puzzle than I was seeing from the business pages or from *Barron's* or *Forbes* magazine. In fact, after my lunch with Mr. Hayes, I was more determined than ever to visit a specialist in action.

He tried to help me with a phone number of an active specialist he knew, but when I called that individual and explained what I wanted, he referred me to the public relations office, which put me right back where I'd started. By now I was willing to try anything, including the following ruse.

I'd learned earlier that the New York Stock Exchange is connected by a corridor to the New York Futures Exchange, a related organization that trades futures, options, and other mysterious vehicles I was determined to avoid. I was tipped off to the existence of this corridor by Daniel Gressel, a professional futures trader and also the husband of Claudia Rosett, the book-review editor of the *Wall Street Journal* who, if she's still there, ought to know I think she's brilliant and has a great flair for reviewing books, and might want to consider this one.

Anyway, her charming husband told me that futures traders routinely hop over into the regular stock exchange to "hedge their positions," and that there was a lot of wandering back and forth through the passageway. He offered to get me onto the floor of the futures exchange. From there I planned to sneak through to the stock exchange on my own.